



ENC 3027 – TOPICS IN TECH COMM

Section: 0M01

College of Arts and Humanities

Dean's Office CAH

Course Information

Term: Spring 2027

Class Meeting Days: M, W

Class Meeting Time: 09:00AM - 10:30AM Class

Meeting Location: TCH 0351 **Modality:** M

Credit Hours: 3.00

Instructor Information

Name: Reliance Enwerem

Title: Assistant Professor

Office Location:

Office Hours: Mondays, Wednesdays 3-5pm and by appointment

Email: re994772@ucf.edu

Course Description

This course is an advanced writing course targeted towards students in across disciplines, especially those in technical fields. through theory and practice, with an emphasis on interdisciplinarity, understanding academic fields and their relationships to each other, developing an academic identity, and fundamentals of data literacy in industry. The course will use an integrative learning approach and have a triangular structure (Mahony et al., 2014) established through class discussions, peer review, as well as individual and group projects. Each week will include a combination of readings, exercises, and discussions.

Online Activities: This course requires substantial independent work: as part of the mixed-mode structure, additional lectures and tutorials will be available through Webcourses, with an emphasis on the iterative development of the semester projects.

Student Learning Outcomes

Students will be able to:

- Develop critical digital and data literacy skills rooted in understanding datafication and the importance of humanistic data methods as corrective approaches
- Identify how dominant data paradigms are embedded in power dynamics and reflect ideologies
- Demonstrate how feminist theory and the dimensions of the *Feminist Data ManifestNO* can provide an analytical lens for data projects
- Express rhetorical choices behind data visualization projects and respectfully evaluate how projects center or erase stories
- Articulate the ethical responsibilities of data collectors, curators, and communicators toward the people their data represents
- Adapt the data humanism framework to projects within their field.

Required Course Materials and Resources

- Al-Hazwani, I., Zhang, K. E., Garrison, L., & Bernard, J. (2025). *Data Humanism Decoded: A Characterization of its Principles to Bridge Data Visualization Researchers and Practitioners* (arXiv:2509.00440). arXiv. <https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2509.00440>
- Couldry, N., & Mejias, U. A. (2019). *The Costs of Connection: How Data Is Colonizing Human Life and Appropriating It for Capitalism*. Stanford University Press.
- Drucker, J. (2020). *Visualization and Interpretation: Humanistic Approaches to Display*. MIT Press.
- Drucker, J. (2021). *The Digital Humanities Coursebook: An Introduction to Digital Methods for Research and Scholarship*. Routledge.
- D'Ignazio, C., & Klein, L. F. (2020). *Data Feminism*. MIT Press.
- Lupi, G. (2017, January 30). Data Humanism: The Revolutionary Future of Data Visualization. *PRINT Magazine*. <https://www.printmag.com/article/data-humanism-future-of-data-visualization/>
- Noble, S. U. (2018). *Algorithms of Oppression: How Search Engines Reinforce Racism*. NYU Press.
- Sutherland, T., Marika, C., T.L, C., Jas, R., & Patricia, G. (2023). The Feminist Data Manifest-NO: An Introduction and Four Reflections. In M. K. Gold & L. F. Klein, *Debates in the Digital Humanities* 2023. University of Minnesota Press.

Course Assessment and Grading Procedure

Points (%)	Assignment Summary
5	Activity Verification - Complete the brief survey posted on Webcourses as soon as possible to confirm your enrollment in the course. As this is required by the university, please attend to it as soon as possible at the start of classes.
15	Analytical essay #1 (DH-focused) - This assignment is aimed at assessing your understanding of key concepts as well as the heuristic for incorporating data humanistic principles and feminist principles of care in data work. Consequently, you will be required to identify digital humanities projects and analyze how they exemplify the heuristic of care, embodiment, contextualization, small data, and subjectivity.
15	Analytical essay #2 (Field-focused) - Here, you will be required to identify a community-facing project relevant to your field and analyze how they exemplify (or not) the heuristic of care, embodiment, contextualization, small data, and subjectivity. This assignment extends your understanding of key concepts as well as the heuristic for incorporating data humanistic principles and feminist principles of care in data work.
25	Multimodal Project – You will work in groups to conduct textual analysis and a multimodal project in the form of a policy brief or community-facing narrative.
20	Presentation – Each group will present their project to the classroom and receive peer feedback.
10	Reflection essay - 1-2 pages accounting for how you moved from close reading through AI interrogation to final product, including what they changed, what they struggled with, and what the process taught them about their own relationship to data. You will also highlight the lessons and implications for your relevant field.
10	Attendance & Class Participation - Brainstorming /prewriting, drafts, peer review, reflections, group work, in-class writing, and other classwork and homework.

Assignment Schedule

Due Date	Assignment Name	Assignment Type	Points (%)
1/15/27	Academic Verification Survey	Quiz	5
2/1/27	Analytical essay #1 (DH-focused)	Assignment	15
2/17/27	Analytical essay #2 (Field-focused)	Assignment	15
3/24/27	Multimodal Project	Assignment	25
4/14/27	Presentation	Assignment	20
4/26/27	Reflection essay	Assignment	10
Every class	Attendance & Class participation		10

Grading Scale

Letter Grade	Percentage (%)
A	94-100
A-	90-93
B+	87-89
B	84-86
B-	80-83
C+	77-79
C	74-76
C-	70-73
D+	67-69
D	64-66
D-	61-63
F	0-60

Class Schedule

Week 1: Course introduction: what does it mean to rehumanize data?

1/11: Syllabus, introductions, goal setting

- Introduction: each student shares what field they come from and one way their field uses data about people
- Discussion post: students share a number that represents them, then explain what the number cannot capture

1/13: Datafication and the Feminist Data Manifest-No

Read:

Drucker, J. (2021). The Digital Humanities Coursebook: An Introduction to Digital Methods for Research and Scholarship. Routledge. <https://doi.org/10.4324/9781003106531> (Ch. 1)

Sutherland, T., Marika, C., T.L, C., Jas, R., & Patricia, G. (2023). The Feminist Data Manifest-NO: An Introduction and Four Reflections. In M. K. Gold & L. F. Klein, Debates in the Digital Humanities 2023. University of Minnesota Press.

- Close reading of the Manifest-No: each student takes one refusal statement and connects it to their field
- Introduction to the five-dimension heuristic: care, embodiment, contextualization, small data, subjectivity
- Discussion: where do you encounter datafication in your daily life and in your discipline?

Week 2: Data Humanism

1/18: MLK Day- No class

1/20: Data humanism and data as capta

Read:

Al-Hazwani, I., Zhang, K. E., Garrison, L., & Bernard, J. (2025). *Data Humanism Decoded: A Characterization of its Principles to Bridge Data Visualization Researchers and Practitioners* (arXiv:2509.00440). arXiv. <https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2509.00440>

Drucker, J. (2011). Humanities Approaches to Graphical Display. Digital Humanities Quarterly, 005(1).

- Introduction to data humanism principles
- Workshop: Applying the five heuristic dimensions to a sample DH project
- Introduction to Analytical Essay 1: begin identifying DH projects this week

Week 3: How DH writes about data

1/25: Workshop

- Workshop: Applying the five heuristic dimensions to sample DH project

1/27: Peer review – Analytical Essay #1

- Submit a rough first draft in advance and arrive with questions.
- Peer-review and Class discussion: what patterns emerged across the DH projects? Which heuristic dimensions were most and least present?
- **Analytical Essay #1 due**

Week 4: How non-DH fields write about data

2/1: Genre analysis: how does your discipline communicate data about people?

Read: D'Ignazio & Klein, "Data Feminism" (2020), Chapter 6: "The Numbers Don't Speak for Themselves" (pp. 149–172)

- You will bring one real example from your field: a report, dashboard, article, or visualization that communicates data about human populations.
- Small group genre analysis: how does this document frame people? What conventions do the genre enforce?
- Discussion: which genres make it easy to erase people, and which make it harder?

2/3: What does it mean to treat data with care?

Read:

Couldry, N., & Mejias, U. A. (2019). The Costs of Connection: How Data Is Colonizing Human Life and Appropriating It for Capitalism. Stanford University Press.

Lupi, G. (2017, January 30). Data Humanism: The Revolutionary Future of Data Visualization. PRINT Magazine. <https://www.printmag.com/article/data-humanism-future-of-data-visualization/>

- Discussion: care vs. objectivity; which does your field likely value over the other? Why?
- Activity: you will examine a public health article and write a "care statement," articulating obligations to the people the data represents

Week 5: Data Humanism in Research and Practice

2/8: Rhetoric & data visualization

Read:

Dear data Project : <https://www.dear-data.com/theproject>

Drucker, J. (2020). *Visualization and Interpretation: Humanistic Approaches to Display*. MIT Press.

- Data visualization as a rhetorical act
- Scale, color, framing, omission as persuasion with examples from public health, finance, and engineering
- In-class analysis: three visualizations of the same dataset examining what does each one argue, and for whom?

• Introduction to Analytical Essay #2

2/10: Whose story does this chart tell?

Read: Noble, S. U. (2018). *Algorithms of Oppression: How Search Engines Reinforce Racism*. NYU Press.

- Workshop: students redesign data visualization from their own field to center a different audience or community
- Peer critique: cross-disciplinary pairs exchange redesigns and evaluate AI and student visualizations using the data humanism heuristic.

Week 6: Conference Week

2/15: Conference I

- Submit an early/ partial/ rough first draft in advance and arrive with questions.
- Visit the writing center.

2/17: Conference II

- Submit an early/ partial/ rough first draft in advance and arrive with questions.
- Visit the writing center.
- **Analytical Essay 2 due**

Week 7: AI and Critical Data Literacy

2/22: What AI does with data and what it cannot do

Read:

DeJeu, E. B. (2024). Using Generative AI to Facilitate Data Analysis and Visualization: A Case Study of Olympic Athletes. *Journal of Business and Technical Communication*, 38(3), 225–241. <https://doi.org/10.1177/10506519241239923>

Littlefield, J. (2025). Stochastic Publics: The Emergence and Ethics of AI-Generated Publics in Technical Communication. *Journal of Business and Technical Communication*, 39(1), 26–41. <https://doi.org/10.1177/10506519241280592>

- Using Claude Artifacts, upload a set of articles or images relevant to your discipline that are either in the public domain or you have the right to use (archival photographs, artwork, maps, data visualizations) and use Claude to analyze, describe, or interpret them.
- Reflect on how AI reads visual material compared to trained humanistic interpretation. What does AI notice, what does it miss, and what would students learn from critically evaluating AI-assisted visual analysis? Try building metadata and creating visual tools for exploring the text.
- Connection: what would happen if your organization relied on AI to communicate data about people?

2/24: Introduction to multimodal project

- Multimodal project overview: policy brief or community-facing narrative
- Forming cross-disciplinary groups: Each group selects 30-50 community-facing text relevant to a field represented in the group (business, finance, data science and analytics, health informatics, etc.).
- Groups begin close reading of their selected articles

Week 8: Analysis

3/1: Workshop Exercise – Data Cleaning and Preparation

Read: Drucker, J. (2021). *The Digital Humanities Coursebook: An Introduction to Digital Methods for Research and Scholarship*. Routledge. (Ch. 2)

- Sources for valid data
- Introduction to data cleaning and qualities of good data

3/3: Textual Analysis.

Clarke, V., & Braun, V. (2017). Thematic analysis. *The Journal of Positive Psychology*, 12(3), 297–298. <https://doi.org/10.1080/17439760.2016.1262613>

- Using Claude Projects and Artifacts, upload a set of texts relevant to your discipline and use Claude to analyze it (identify patterns, compare passages, build a concordance, and/or explore a corpus; we'll discuss what this might look like in the workshop, so be sure to watch

the video if you can't attend).

- Reflect on the strengths and limitations of AI-assisted textual analysis compared to traditional close reading.

Week 9: Data Analysis, Visualization, and Playful pedagogy

3/8: Data Analysis & Visualization

[ASCEND](#) model for data visualization

- Introduction to data analysis using Voyant, Gephi, Power BI, Tableau and any other tool relevant to student's discipline
- In groups of 2, students will analyze and visualize a dataset independently, without using AI and the other group will use Claude to analyze same dataset.

3/10: Playful pedagogy

Read: Johnson, E., & Salter, A. (2025). *Critical Making in the Age of AI*. Amherst College Press.

- Discussion: what would it look like to design a data project playfully, even in a technical field?
- Explore agentic uses of Claude to create interactive data narratives
- **Multimodal Project draft due**

Week 10: Spring Break

Week 11: Group Conference

3/22: Group conference I

3/24: Group conference II

- **Multimodal project due**

Week 12: Introduction to Ubuntu

3/29: Ubuntu: I am because we are

Read:

Ewuoso, C., & Hall, S. (2019). Core aspects of ubuntu: A systematic review. South African Journal of Bioethics and Law, 12(2), 93. <https://doi.org/10.7196/SAJBL.2019.v12i2.679>

Ramose, M. B. (1999). African Philosophy Through Ubuntu. Mond Books.

- Ubuntu as a counter-framework to datafication's individualism
- Discussion: what does it mean to treat knowledge as communal rather than individual and how does that challenge the way your field works?
- How does Ubuntu inform the group work you just completed?

3/31: Presenting Across Disciplines

Explore: [UCF Digital Accessibility Guides](#).

- Structuring an accessible presentation that speaks across disciplines.
- Peer-feedback protocol: Introduction of rubric groups will use to give structured feedback on classmates' presentations.

Week 13: Presentations

4/5: Group presentations I

4/7: Group presentations II

Week 14: Reflection

4/12: Group presentations III

4/14: Group presentations IV

- **Introduction to the reflection essay**

Week 15: Reflection

4/19: **What has this course changed?**

- Discussion: revisit the heuristic with fresh eyes; which dimension do you understand differently now than in Week 1?
- Discussion post: you will revisit your Week 1 "number that represents me" exercise and rewrite it with what they now know

4/21: **AI position**

- AI for critical making, design, data analysis and visualization.
- Discussion: Has this course changed your perspective towards AI usage in your field? How do you view AI in relation to your field and data humanism.

Week 16: Final Reflection essay due

4/26: Visit the writing center

- **Reflection essay due**

Artificial Intelligence Policy

This course treats AI the way it treats data: as something powerful, imperfect, and never neutral. We will use AI (Claude) as a pedagogical tool. You will prompt Claude to build data artifacts, interrogate what it produces, and identify what it centers and erases. You will ask Claude to do things it cannot do well, and you will learn as much from those failures as from its successes. Articulating what you want an AI to do with data forces you to name your own values, assumptions, and rhetorical choices—and that is at the core of this course.

If you encounter access barriers at any point (technical, financial, or otherwise), please tell me and we will find a workaround.

How to Use AI in this course

1. **Experiment freely:** Try things. Utilize the agentic capabilities of Claude. Give it a dataset and see what it builds with no guidance, then give it the same dataset with every principle from this course encoded in the prompt and compare. The exercises in this course are designed so that the omissions and mistakes are learning points.
2. **Disclose honestly:** When you submit work that incorporates AI-generated content, show your process. State that you used Claude, describe what you asked it to do, and include screenshots of your full prompt and Claude's response. Your prompts are often the most interesting part of your submission, because they reveal what you were thinking before Claude responded.
3. **Exploration vs. Critical thinking:** You may use AI for brainstorming, exploration, and artifact generation. However, your comparative reflections, heuristic evaluations, and re-imagined narratives must be substantively your own. You have to decide what matters in it and why.

Policies for Course Grade

Assignment Submission and Grading Policy

Students can access their grades and feedback at any time using the Grade Book function of Webcourses. All assignments will be submitted through Webcourses. Plan on checking the site at least twice a week for updates and assignment information. Grades are calculated out of 100 following a standard letter scale.

Missed/Late Assignments

Late work is accepted without penalty through one week after the assignment deadline. If circumstances require extension beyond that deadline, please reach out to the instructor immediately. As assignments throughout the course are designed to build on the previous exercise, assignments must be completed in sequence.

Incompletes are not generally granted unless there are exceptional circumstances. In these rare cases, incompletes will not be granted for students with more than two missing assignments, and must be resolved within six months of the end of the course.

Extra Credit Policy

There is no extra credit work available in this class. Grades will be available through Webcourses and updated weekly.

Mixed Methods Course Structure

This course uses a mixed mode format, and relies upon students to complete all readings, engage with online videos, and complete tutorials as assigned. All assignments are due at the close of their listed module, but will be accepted with no penalty for one week after the deadline. Once an assignment closes, late work will not be accepted unless an additional extension has already been approved by the instructor: please reach out early if circumstances will require additional time!

- The course will meet at the scheduled time on campus unless otherwise noted in the weekly module.
- In-person class sessions will not be recorded.
- Office hour assistance is additionally available both through text on Webcourses messages and via Zoom.

In the event of an emergency or medical challenge, additional flexibility beyond the grading guidelines is available: when anticipated, students should reach out to the instructor as soon as feasible to form a plan or discuss an incomplete if needed.

Remember to complete the listed readings for each week prior to class, and be prepared for discussion.

Disability Access & Accommodations

The University of Central Florida is committed to providing equal access to all students with

disabilities (ADHD, learning disabilities, Autism, chronic medical conditions, physical disabilities, etc.). To receive consideration for reasonable disability-related course accommodations, disabled students must contact Student Accessibility Services (SAS) and complete the steps required for SAS to review accommodation requests. More information can be found on the UCF [Student Accessibility Services](#) website under the Start Here tab or by contacting SAS directly (Ferrell Commons 185; sas@ucf.edu; Phone - 407-823-2371).

Approved accommodations are shared with course instructors via the SAS Course Accessibility Letter. Implementing certain accommodations may require discussion about specific considerations of the course design, course learning objectives, and the individual academic and course challenges experienced by the student. While students with disabilities or chronic health needs are also encouraged to discuss any course concerns with professors in addition to contacting SAS, professors are not required to facilitate disability-related adjustments to the course unless the professor has received a Course Accessibility Letter from SAS that outlines approved accommodations.

Academic Integrity

Students should familiarize themselves with UCF's Code of Conduct at Student Conduct and Integrity Office. According to Section 1, "Academic Misconduct," students are prohibited from engaging in:

1. Academic misconduct is defined as any submitted work or behavior that obstructs the instructor of record's ability to accurately assess the student's understanding or completion of course materials or degree requirements (e.g., assignment, quiz, and/or exam). Examples of academic misconduct include but are not limited to: plagiarism, unauthorized assistance to complete an academic exercise; unauthorized communication with others during an examination, course assignment, or project; falsifying or misrepresenting academic work; providing misleading information to create a personal advantage to complete course/degree requirements; or multiple submission(s) of academic work without permission of the instructor of record.
2. Any student who knowingly helps another violate academic behavior standards is also in violation of the standards.
3. Commercial Use of Academic Material. Selling of course material to another person and/or uploading course material to a third-party vendor without authorization or without the express permission of the University and the instructor of record. Course materials include but are not limited to class notes, the instructor of record's slide deck, tests, quizzes, labs, instruction sheets, homework, study guides, and handouts.

4. Soliciting assistance with academic coursework and/or degree requirements. The solicitation of assistance with an assignment, lab, quiz, test, paper, etc., without authorization of the instructor of record or designee is prohibited. This includes but is not limited to asking for answers to a quiz, trading answers, or offering to pay another to complete an assignment. It is considered Academic Misconduct to solicit assistance with academic coursework and/or degree requirements, even if the solicitation did not yield actual assistance (for example, if there was no response to the solicitation).

Responses to Academic Dishonesty, Plagiarism, or Cheating

Students should also familiarize themselves with the procedures for academic misconduct in UCF's student handbook, [The Golden Rule](#). UCF faculty members have a responsibility for students' education and the value of a UCF degree, and so seek to prevent unethical behavior and respond to academic misconduct when necessary.

Penalties for violating rules, policies, and instructions within this course can range from a zero on the exercise to an "F" letter grade in the course. In addition, an Academic Misconduct report could be filed with the Office of Student Conduct and Academic Integrity, which could lead to disciplinary warning, disciplinary probation, or deferred suspension or separation from the University through suspension, dismissal, or expulsion with the addition of a "Z" designation on one's transcript.

Being found in violation of academic conduct standards could result in a student having to disclose such behavior on a graduate school application, being removed from a leadership position within a student organization, the recipient of scholarships, participation in University activities such as study abroad, internships, etc.

Let's avoid all of this by demonstrating values of honesty, trust, and integrity. No grade is worth compromising your integrity and moving your moral compass. Stay true to doing the right thing: take the zero, not a shortcut.

Title IX

Title IX prohibits sex discrimination, including sexual misconduct, sexual violence, sexual harassment, and retaliation. If you or someone you know has been harassed or assaulted, you can find resources available to support the victim, including confidential resources and information concerning reporting options at [Let's Be Clear](#) and [UCF Cares](#).

For more information on access and community engagement, Title IX, accessibility, or UCF's complaint processes contact:

- Title IX – ONAC – [Office of Nondiscrimination & Accommodations Compliance](#) &

askanadvocate@ucf.edu

- Disability Accommodation – Student Accessibility Services – [Student Accessibility Services](#) & sas@ucf.edu
- [Access and Community Engagement](#) (including the Ginsberg Center for Inclusion and Community Engagement, Military and Veteran Student Success, and HSI Initiatives)
- UCF Compliance and Ethics Office – [Compliance, Ethics, and Risk Office](#) & complianceandethics@ucf.edu
- The [Ombuds Office](#) is a safe place to discuss concerns.

Reporting an Incident or Issue

If you believe you have experienced discrimination by any faculty or staff member, contact the Office of Nondiscrimination & Accommodations Compliance via the [ONAC website](#) or at 407-823-1336. You can also choose to report using the UCF Integrity Line either anonymously or as yourself at 1-855-877-6049 or by using the [online form](#). UCF cares about you and takes every report seriously. For more information see the [Reporting an Incident or Issue Webpage](#).

Deployed Active-Duty Military Students

Students who are deployed active-duty military and/or National Guard personnel and require accommodation should contact their instructors as soon as possible after the semester begins and/or after they receive notification of deployment to make arrangements.

Campus Safety

At UCF's Public Safety and Police, safety is the top priority. Emergencies on campus are rare, but if one should arise, it's important to be familiar with some basic safety and security concepts.

- In an emergency, always dial 911.
- Every UCF Classroom has an Emergency Procedure Guide posted on a wall near the door, which will show you how to respond to a variety of situations. This guide can also be found online [here](#).
- In the event of an active threat, remember **AVOID, DENY, DEFEND**. Choose the best course of action and act immediately. Watch the video [here](#) to learn more.
 - **AVOID**. Pay attention to your surroundings and have an exit plan. Get as much distance and as many barriers between you and the threat as quickly as possible.
 - **DENY**. When avoiding is difficult or impossible, deny the threat access to you and

your space. Lockdown by creating barriers, turning the lights off and remaining quiet and out of sight. Make sure your cell phone is silenced, but do not turn it off.

- **DEFEND.** When you are unable to put distance between yourself and the threat, be prepared to protect yourself. Commit to your actions, be aggressive and do not fight fairly. Do whatever it takes to survive.
- For emergencies on campus, UCF will utilize the [UCF Alert](#) system. All UCF students, faculty, and staff are automatically enrolled to receive these email and text alerts, however, it's a good idea to frequently ensure your [contact information is up to date](#).

Financial Aid Accountability

All instructors/faculty are required to document students' academic activity at the beginning of each course. In order to document that you began this course, please complete this activity by the end of the first week of classes or as soon as possible after adding the course. Failure to do so may result in a delay in the disbursement of your financial aid.